

Clarification questions (Podman session pre-read)

Clarifications with dev / platform team

Purpose: Questions for the client dev lead (and client platform as needed) to close Workshop 1 gaps, align , and unblock Track A (RHEL) + Track B (network).

How to use: Schedule 45–60 min; send list in advance; record answers in this doc or meeting notes. Tag each answer: **Decided** / **TBD** / **Owner** / **Due**.

Scope: **In scope** = consultant documents/advises **Client** = Client dev lead/team executes **Out of scope** = redirect (app, network build, licensing).

1. Engagement scope & charter

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
1.1	Confirm focus is stabilize dev Podman → UAT → first prod Linux (no prod Linux today), not contract Ubuntu→RHEL wording?	Aligns vs	In scope
1.2	Is WSL2/Ubuntu on laptops staying, or moving dev to RHEL VMs ?	Standards + CI parity	Client decision
1.3	Who is primary approver (Client platform, Client dev lead, CAB)?	Changes and cutover	Client
1.4	Environments in scope: prod only , or prod + UAT + dev + DR?	Phase plan	In scope
1.5	Freeze / blackout dates for prod?	Scheduling	Client
1.6	Is consultant delivering reference IaC only , or expected to apply in Azure?	Scope boundary	Out of scope: apply unless CO
1.7	Is golden image / AIB / SIG in plan, or in-place harden of current VM?	Repo vs Ansible path	Advisory

2. Development environment (WSL vs server)

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
2.1	Today: do developers only use WSL locally, or also SSH to a Linux server for dev?	Line 90–91 in workshop	Client
2.2	Is there a shared dev Linux VM (separate from prod), or only laptop + prod?	User isolation need	Client
2.3	If shared server: one Linux account per developer or shared login today?	Security (Q4)	Client
2.4	Planned user isolation : separate users, subfolders only, or dev VMs per person?	Standards	Advisory draft
2.5	Should prod allow interactive SSH for developers, or CI/CD + Bastion only?	Prod hardening	Advisory
2.6	Same container images built locally (WSL) and in CI as on dev/UAT?	Parity	Client / app
2.7	Does CI (GitHub Actions) run on RHEL , Ubuntu, or container-only runners?	Catch OS drift	Client

3. Production & UAT VMs (Azure RHEL)

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
3.1	Hostname, subscription, resource group, region of prod Linux VM?	Assessment access	Client
3.2	VM size, OS disk + data disk layout (what's on each)?	Mount issue	Client
3.3	How is the extra data drive mounted today (fstab, UUID, manual)? Who fixes?	Reboot data loss	Client executes
3.4	RHEL version and subscription (RHSM, Satellite, BYOS)?	Patching	Client owns license
3.5	UAT : exists today or greenfield? Same VM pattern as prod?	Phase 3	In scope plan
3.6	Dev "fixed before UAT" (D4): what is broken in dev today specifically?	Sequencing	Client
3.7	Timeline to stand up UAT after assessment?	Roadmap	Client
3.8	In-place prod harden vs new VM + cutover preference?	Risk	Client decides

4. Podman & applications (dev today)

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
4.1	List of Podman services on dev (names, compose/quadlet files, systemd units)?	Inventory	Client
4.2	Where do images come from (GHCR, ACR, local build on server)?	Supply chain	Client
4.3	SELinux errors today—which paths/containers fail?	Known issue	Client fixes
4.4	Rootful vs rootless Podman?	Hardening	Advisory
4.5	Secrets in env files, Key Vault, or mixed?	Standards	Advisory
4.6	Connection details for Snowflake, SQL Server, trading, optimization —static IPs, DNS, private link?	Network allow-list	Client + network
4.7	Any app changes expected for RHEL (libraries, paths)—who owns testing?	Out of scope: app remediation	App team
4.8	Kubernetes timeline: assess only, pilot date, or not planned 12 months?	Scope creep	Advisory assess

5. CI/CD & deployment

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
5.1	GitHub Actions flow: branch → which env → prod? Manual approvals?	Runbooks	In scope
5.2	What is deployed to server (git pull, docker compose pull, scripts, Ansible)?	Repeatability	Client
5.3	Downtime acceptable per deploy? Maintenance windows?	Cutover	Client
5.4	Who can deploy to prod today (people, service accounts)?	Access model	Client
5.5	Rollback process if deploy fails?	Runbook	Advisory draft

6. Consultant access

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
6.1	Consultant email / Teams — fully working?	Collaboration	Client
6.2	SSH or Bastion access to dev Linux VM for read-only assessment?	Phase 1	Done — Consultant has Linux VM access
6.3	Read-only Azure RBAC on dev + prod subscriptions?	Track B; VM Azure context	Pending — request Reader from client platform
6.4	Ongoing access duration and escalation (Client dev lead, Client platform)?	SOW KT period	In scope
6.5	NDA / data handling on prod (PII, trading data)—snapshots allowed?	Compliance	Client GRC

7. Network & integrations (loop in client platform / network if needed)

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
7.1	Architecture diagram (Azure + hybrid + Linux box)—who delivers by when?	Blocker	Client (Client dev lead)
7.2	Prod VM: public IP , private only, VPN/ExpressRoute to access?	Security	Client / network
7.3	Egress from VM: direct Internet, proxy, firewall in path?	Patch, Snowflake, GH	Network
7.4	NGINX on VM: stay, move to APIM/Front Door when?	Separate workstream	Out of scope unless CO
7.5	Two tenants (lower vs prod): which VM in which?	Assessment	Client

Full network list: Workshop 2.

8. Monitoring, DR, operations

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
8.1	Logic Monitor rollout for this Linux host—timeline?	Q5	Client (Client platform)
8.2	What is monitored today (OS, Podman/containers, disks, APIs)?	Gaps	Client
8.3	ASR for this VM: configured, tested, includes data disk?	DR	Client executes test
8.4	Backup policy (Azure Backup, snapshots)—RPO/RTO expectations?	Standards	Client
8.5	On-call for Linux incidents —who? Hiring Linux admin still planned?	Ops model	Client
8.6	Patching cadence for RHEL (monthly, autoupdate)?	Standards	Advisory

9. Security & compliance

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
9.1	FIPS required for these apps now or later?	Crypto policy	App + client test
9.2	CIS / internal hardening baseline required?	Standards	In scope advise
9.3	AD / SSO for SSH or local users only?	Account model	Client identity
9.4	Break-glass / emergency access process?	Runbook	Advisory
9.5	Claude Code pilot—any impact on server tooling policy?	Awareness	Out of scope

10. Documentation & deliverables

#	Question	Why it matters	Scope
10.1	High-level schema Client dev lead offered—format and due date?	Follow-up task	Client
10.2	Existing runbooks , architecture docs, passwords in KV?	Discovery	Client provides
10.3	Preferred format for standards (Word, Confluence, repo markdown)?	Deliverable	Client
10.4	Review cadence: weekly with client dev lead + Client platform?	Engagement	In scope

11. Out of scope — confirm redirects

Confirm Client dev lead agrees consultant will **not**:

- Fix application code or container image bugs
- Implement firewall rules or build hub/spoke
- Purchase RHEL licenses
- Run prod `terraform apply` or operate monitoring 24x7
- Build AKS / APIM in this engagement

#	Question
11.1	Agree on redirects to app team, network team, procurement?
11.2	Any item client still expects from Consultant outside list above?

Answer log (fill in meeting)

#	Answer	Owner	Due	Status
1.1	No production Linux environments	Client	—	Confirmed
1.2	Dev hosts = Podman; WSL/Ubuntu on laptops TBD	Client	—	Confirmed
1.7	Golden image optional for UAT/prod fleet	Advisory	—	Open
3.1–3.5	Prod Linux greenfield after UAT	Client	—	Confirmed
W2-Q9	Podman (not Docker) on dev	Client	—	Confirmed
6.2	Linux VM access for consultant	Client	—	Done
6.3	Azure subscription Reader for consultant	Client platform	[date]	Pending
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- (#13 RHEL assessment)